

Preface

Electroencephalography (EEG) is a powerful test that can provide valuable insight into cerebral functioning. However, most clinicians, including neurologists who don't routinely read EEGs, find them complex and confusing. The lack of standardization among experienced electroencephalographers adds to this perception. Although many excellent atlases and reference texts exist, the need for a simple guide has been long felt. This book aims to fill that void with a stepwise approach. It enables readers, especially trainees, to confidently interpret EEGs and benefit their patients.

This approach borrows heavily from those of my teachers at the Edward B. Bromfield, MD comprehensive epilepsy program at the Brigham and Women's Hospital and the intra operative neurophysiology unit at Massachusetts General Hospital. I also gratefully acknowledge my clinical colleagues and technicians at the University of Massachusetts. I wish to thank Lenora Ocava, Peter Mabie, Mark Milstein and Matthew Robbins for inspiring me to study neurology and my colleagues Azad Irani, Jerestyn Khopoliwalla, Angeliki Vgontzas, Rachel Passannante, Kelsey Goostrey, Matthew Schrettner, Lu Lin, Claire Joubert, Kyle Rossi, Behnaz Esmaeli, Felicia Chu, Mugdha Mohanty, Minh Lang, Celia Gomes McGillivray, Ika Noviauwaty, Jess Slammin and Don Chin for their encouragement. This book would have been impossible without the tolerance of my wife, Shilpa, and the support of our family and friends. Last but not least, I thank Anna Whiting, Camille-Lee Own, and Deborah van Wyk at Cambridge University Press for making this possible.

I hope you enjoy it.